

ZUARI RAIN FOREST
Goa
Area of entire development: **20 acres**
Area of houses: **800-2,600 sq. ft**
Price: **Rs 75 lakh (starting price)**



MAHINDRA MERIDIAN
Alibaug, Maharashtra
Area of entire development: **N/A**
Area of houses: **3,000-3,300 sq. ft**
Price: **Rs 4.1 crore**



DLF SAMAVANA, SOLAN
Himachal Pradesh
Area of entire development: **58 acres**
Area of houses: **560-2,096 sq. ft**
Price: **Rs 1.05 crore (starting price)**

SHOBHAN KOTHARI
Architect and Partner, ADND

"THE MAJOR REQUIREMENTS THAT PEOPLE HAVE FROM A SECOND HOME IS THAT IT SHOULD BE WELL-VENTILATED, WELL-LIT AND WELL-CONNECTED WITH THE OUTDOORS"

such farms to be an active part of the overall process. Such collectives not only help connect people with similar passions but also provide a healthier environment to live in. "I lived in Noida because of work, but apart from that I felt no real connection to the NCR area," says Virah Kapur. "I did not know my neighbours, I was not interested in the local problems and I never enjoyed my life there," says the 33-year-old. The minute Kapur, an expat placement consultant, began working remotely, he grabbed the opportunity to rent out a second flat on the outskirts of Nainital. "My neighbours and I together have set up a lush green terrace farm and I'm now involved in teaching the children of my house help. It is a smaller community, but I feel more cared for, more invested in my surroundings." In November 2021, he moved his mother from Delhi to live with him in Nainital due to health concerns. "She was having trouble breathing in the city. It was difficult to get her to leave our ancestral home but it was a matter of her health and overall quality of life."

BREATHING FREE

Pollution is one of the greatest fears of city dwellers. Delhi recorded an increase of 125 per cent in NO_2 (nitrogen dioxide) pollution between April 2020 and April 2021, according to a Greenpeace India study which analysed NO_2 concentrations in India's eight most populous state capitals—Mumbai, Delhi, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Chennai, Kolkata, Jaipur and Lucknow. Pollution from NO_2 increased in all of the eight cities surveyed. And the increase has had its impact on the overall respiratory health of many residents.

Dr Davinder Kundra, a Delhi-based pulmonologist, says: "The elderly find life in polluted spaces particularly difficult because their lungs are already weakened by age. Moreover, many are forced by their families to stay indoors when the pollution is high and this impacts their mental and physical wellbeing in other ways—the stress of not going out, of not being able to meet people, of not being mobile and independent."

The winter of 2021 was particularly difficult for residents in high-pollution areas. Tarun Mahar, 51, was confined to his home in Noida for almost a month after his asthma was aggravated. He had already survived a severe bout of Covid earlier in the year. In December, he decided to move in with a friend at the latter's family home in Palakkad, Kerala. "I loved it so much that I am now looking to buy a place of my own here. The air is clean, almost heady with freshness, and I have found it far easier to breathe here," he says.

OTHER STRESS TRIGGERS

Pollution, though, isn't the only factor impacting health in cities. Other health concerns are also driving people to smaller towns and cities. A survey by community social media platform LocalCircles found that 45 per cent of the people surveyed in Delhi knew someone in their family or local social network who had been impacted by dengue in 2021. The survey was conducted among 14,974 Delhi-NCR